

Japan Video Gaming

Konami Group Corporation

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

9766.JP

27,200 JPY (26,800 OLD)

31 July 2026

Estimate Change



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Konami Q1: Football won, eFootball won too

Beating the referees. Konami's Q1 results were very strong, driven by World Cup engagement powering eFootball revenue to c. 78% growth this quarter, versus us modeling 69% growth. JPY130bn of group revenue (+33.6% year on year) was 8.0% and 5.9% ahead of us and street consensus (JPY120bn and JPY122bn). JPY45.3bn of operating profit was 63.3% higher than a year ago, and was 21.5% and 17.7% ahead of us and consensus (JPY37.3bn and JPY38.5bn). Within this, JPY43.9bn of Digital Entertainment operating profit beat our estimate and consensus by either side of 25%, while folks at Konami's smaller businesses spent the quarter watching the football.

Extra time - Q2 guidance strong. JPY52bn of aggregate eFootball revenue in Q1 was split across c. JPY43bn mobile and JPY9bn for console/PC. With July billings from Sensor Tower looking 24% higher than June levels, and 36% higher than the Q2 monthly average, management unsurprisingly guided for eFootball revenue in Q2 to be "at least flat" versus Q1. With MGS Master Collection Vol. 2 and Silent Hill: Townfall launching too, it should follow that Q2 group operating profit will be higher than Q1. Zooming out, we remain of the view that Konami will continue to grow solidly, driven by eFootball user and monetization growth, lower mobile platform fees, and single-title game progress.

The fight after the final whistle? We'd expect Konami's shares to react positively to these results. The World Cup has come and gone. But management struck a confident tone on the analyst call, pointing to ongoing market growth for eFootball, and strong retention of users acquired during the World Cup. Some of the discourse we'd heard approaching the quarter centred around a possible dull period as Konami pulls back on eFootball monetization later this year. But if we assume stocks trade on fundamentals 6-9 months ahead, investors selling Konami now risk making the same mistake as buying Konami in January. Also, do stocks dip when everyone's lining up to buy the dip?

Investment Implications

We rate Konami Outperform (PT JPY27,200).

Reported EPS	F26A	F27E	F28E	Financials	F26A	F27E	F28E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F26A	F27E	F28E
9766.JP (JPY)	737.79	927.59	1,065.68	Revenues (M)	493,677	550,524	580,217	8.4%	Reported P/E (x)	29.6	23.5	20.5
OLD	--	896.16	1,032.05	Gross Profit (M)	243,179	281,424	301,534	--	EV/Sales (x)	5.8	5.2	4.9
				Operating Earnings (M)	135,891	173,362	198,877	--	EV/EBIT (x)	20.8	16.4	14.3
				Net Earnings (M)	100,013	125,740	144,458	--				

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

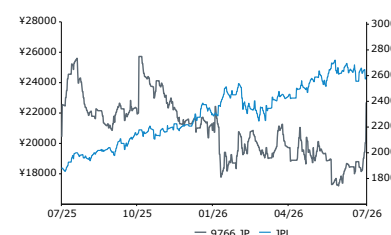
See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

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Close Date	30 Jul 2026
9766.JP Close Price (JPY)	21,840
Price Target (JPY)	27,200
Upside/(Downside)	25%
52-Week Range	26,645/16,850
JPL	2,570.52
FYE	Mar
Div Yield	1.0%
Market Cap (JPY) (B)	3,134.04
EV (JPY) (B)	2,857.89
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	2.4 23.6 (2.8) 7.3
JPL (%)	16.5 (1.9) 11.5 37.4
Relative (%)	(14.1) 25.5 (14.3) (30.1)
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.	

Price Performance, 1YR



DETAILS

78% EFOOTBALL GROWTH DRIVES Q1 BEAT, Q2 GUIDANCE STRONG

Konami's Q1 FY3/27 results were very strong, with World Cup engagement driving eFootball revenue growth. Group revenue of JPY130bn (+33.6% year on year) was 8% above our estimate (JPY120bn), and 5.9% higher than Street consensus on JPY122bn. Digital Entertainment revenue hit JPY100bn, 36.5% higher year on year, 7.1% and 6.2% ahead of our estimate (JPY93.5bn) and consensus (JPY94.2bn). JPY45.3bn of group operating profit was 63.3% higher year on year, and beat us and consensus (JPY37.3bn and JPY38.5bn) by 21.5% and 17.7%. JPY43.9bn of Digital Entertainment operating profit beat us and consensus (JPY34.6bn and JPY35.6bn) by 26.9% and 23.3%.

Breaking down the digital segment, mobile revenue (JPY65.4bn, 65% higher year on year) was higher than we'd modeled (JPY62.8bn), while console/PC revenues (JPY19.9bn, 42.1% higher year on year) was similarly above. JPY14bn of trading card revenue was 6.9% higher year on year. eFootball revenue this quarter was split JPY9bn and JPY43bn across console/PC and mobile.

A strong Q1 was expected for Konami, but JPY45.3bn operating profit was at the high end of what we'd heard from investors into the quarter, which should argue for a positive reaction. With eFootball billings continuing to rise in July, management pointed to exceptional retention of users acquired during the World Cup... and guided eFootball revenues to be "at least flat" in Q2 versus Q1. It should logically follow that Konami's Q2 operating profit will also be higher than Q1.

A period of slower eFootball monetisation is likely thereafter, in the second half of FY3/27E. The company pointed to new features aimed at newly acquired users in the upcoming summer update in August. On the single-title game front, Silent Hill Townfall orders were said to have been "very strong", while Castlevania Belmont's Curse was described as the first of many in a reboot for the series.

Our latest Konami price target reflects updated earnings estimates on a 25x FY+1 PE target multiple (previously 26x).

Exhibit 1 and Exhibit 2 show summaries of Konami's Q1 results, and comparisons with our estimates and consensus.

EXHIBIT 1: Konami: Q1 FY3/27 earnings summary

Konami Q1 FY3/27 results		Q1 FY3/27	Delta		Growth YoY	
		Jun-26	vs. Bernstein	vs. Cons.	Actual	Cons.
Revenue	Actual	129,524	8.0%	5.9%	33.6%	26.2%
	Bernstein	119,954				
	Consensus	122,334				
Gross profit	Actual	70,244	12.6%	11.3%	46.5%	31.6%
	Bernstein	62,396				
	Consensus	63,100				
Gross margin	Actual	54.2%	2.2%	2.7%	4.8%	2.1%
	Bernstein	52.0%				
	Consensus	51.6%				
Operating profit	Actual	45,285	21.5%	17.7%	63.3%	38.7%
	Bern. Est.	37,262				
	Consensus	38,473				
Operating margin	Actual	35.0%	3.9%	3.5%	6.4%	2.8%
	Bern. Est.	31.1%				
	Consensus	31.4%				
Net profit	Actual	32,574	20.0%	15.2%	64.2%	42.6%
	Bernstein	27,145				
	Consensus	28,280				
Non-GAAP EPS	Actual	240.30	20.0%	17.2%	64.2%	40.1%
	Bernstein	200.25				
	Consensus	204.98				

Source: Bloomberg, Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 2: Konami: Q1 FY3/27 segment summary

<u>Segment revenue</u>	<u>Q1 FY3/27 Jun-26</u>	<u>Growth YoY</u>	<u>Bernstein Jun-26</u>	<u>Delta</u>	<u>Consensus Jun-26</u>	<u>Delta</u>
Total revenue	129,524	33.6%	119,954	8.0%	122,334	5.9%
Digital Entertainment	100,083	36.5%	93,477	7.1%	94,238	6.2%
Amusement	4,312	-5.3%	7,000	-38.4%	5,449	-20.9%
Gaming & Systems	12,388	64.9%	7,713	60.6%	9,178	35.0%
Sports	12,712	5.2%	12,329	3.1%	12,514	1.6%
Eliminations	-649	30.6%	-565	-14.9%	-633	-2.5%

<u>Segment operating profit</u>	<u>Q1 FY3/27 Jun-26</u>	<u>Growth YoY</u>	<u>Bernstein Jun-26</u>	<u>Delta</u>	<u>Consensus Jun-26</u>	<u>Delta</u>
Total operating profit	45,285	63.3%	37,262	21.5%	38,473	17.7%
Digital Entertainment	43,870	57.4%	34,561	26.9%	35,587	23.3%
Amusement	929	69.8%	1,400	-33.6%	820	13.3%
Gaming & Systems	827	-598.2%	1,543	-46.4%	1,022	-19.1%
Sports	764	79.3%	558	36.9%	664	15.1%
Corporate expenses and eliminations	-1,718	82.2%	-800	-114.8%	-1,117	-53.9%
Operating margin	35.0%	6.4%	31.1%	3.9%	31.4%	3.5%
Digital Entertainment	43.8%	5.8%	37.0%	6.9%	37.8%	6.1%
Amusement	21.5%	9.5%	20.0%	1.5%	15.0%	6.5%
Gaming & Systems	6.7%	8.9%	20.0%	-13.3%	11.1%	-4.5%
Sports	6.0%	2.5%	4.5%	1.5%	5.3%	0.7%

Source: Bloomberg, Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

UPDATING OUR ESTIMATES FOR KONAMI

We've updated our estimates for Konami to reflect Q1 reporting, and the latest high-frequency data for the company's various games (notably strong eFootball mobile billings in July). Overall our estimates are modestly higher versus prior levels.

Exhibit 3 shows a summary of our estimate changes.

EXHIBIT 3: Konami: Summary of estimate changes

Summary of estimate changes	FY3/27E	FY3/28E	FY3/29E
Revenue (JPY bn)			
Bernstein - old	539	571	592
Growth YoY	14.0%	5.8%	3.8%
Bernstein - new	551	580	604
Growth YoY	11.5%	5.4%	4.1%
Consensus	546	579	618
Growth YoY	13.8%	5.9%	6.8%
Bernstein new vs. old	2.1%	1.6%	2.0%
Bernstein new vs. consensus	0.8%	0.3%	-2.2%
Operating profit (JPY bn)			
Bernstein - old	167	193	214
Growth YoY	28.6%	15.3%	11.0%
Margin	31.0%	33.7%	36.1%
Bernstein - new	173	199	221
Growth YoY	27.6%	14.7%	11.4%
Margin	31.5%	34.3%	36.7%
Consensus	166	182	198
Growth YoY	25.8%	9.6%	8.6%
Margin	30.4%	31.5%	32.0%
Bernstein new vs. old	3.8%	3.3%	3.6%
Bernstein new vs. consensus	4.3%	9.2%	11.9%
EPS (JPY)			
Bernstein - old	896	1,032	1,145
Growth YoY	28.1%	15.2%	10.9%
Bernstein - new	928	1,066	1,186
Growth YoY	25.7%	14.9%	11.3%
Consensus	885	970	1,059
Growth YoY	25.7%	9.6%	9.2%
Bernstein new vs. old	3.5%	3.3%	3.6%
Bernstein new vs. consensus	4.8%	9.9%	12.0%

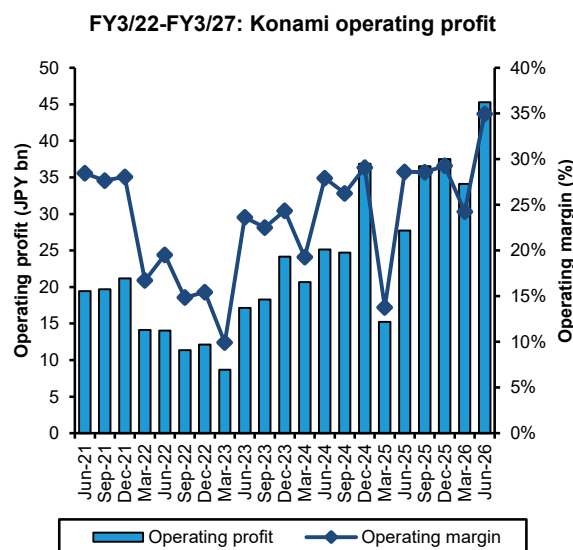
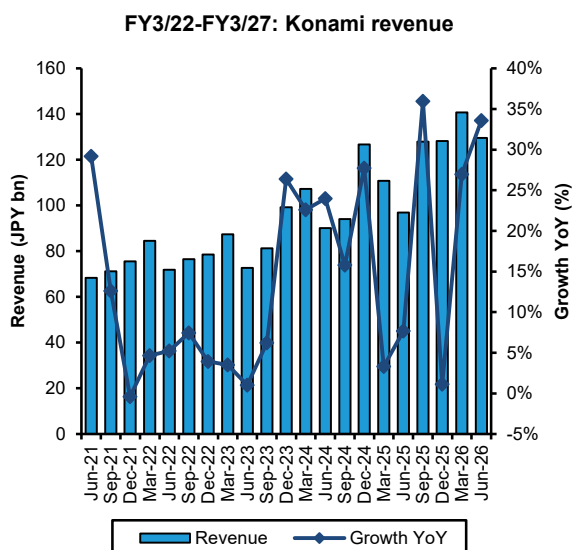
Source: Bloomberg, Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Q1 FY3/27 REPORTING IN CHARTS

Exhibit 4 to Exhibit 8 show a selection of charts which summarise Konami's June quarter print, and prior quarterly trends.

EXHIBIT 4: Konami revenue was JPY129.5bn in the June quarter, 33.6% higher year on year

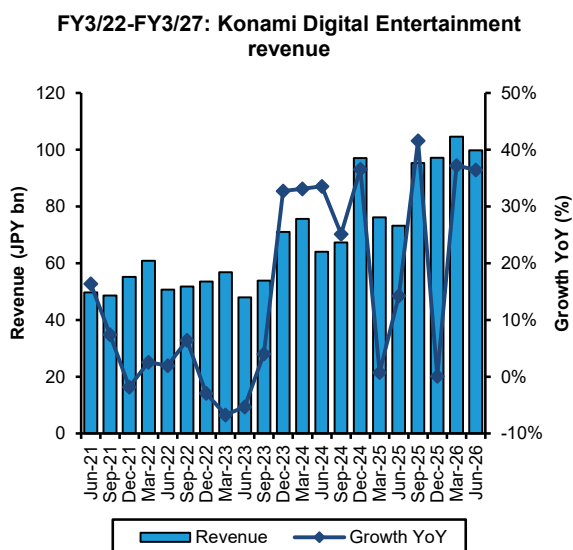
OPERATING :



Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

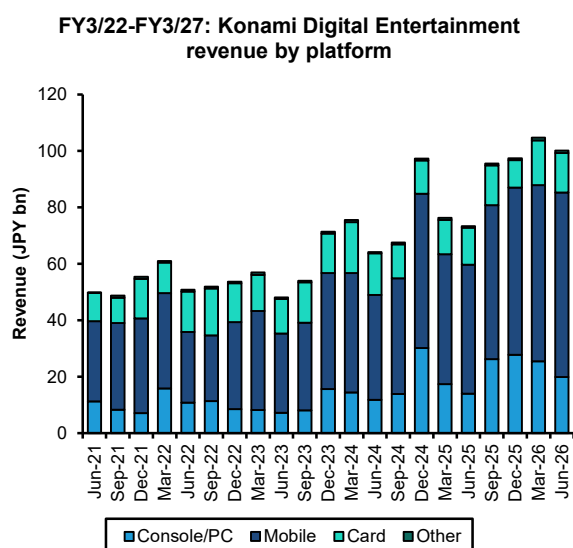
Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 5: Digital Entertainment external revenue of JPY99.8bn was 36.4% higher year on year



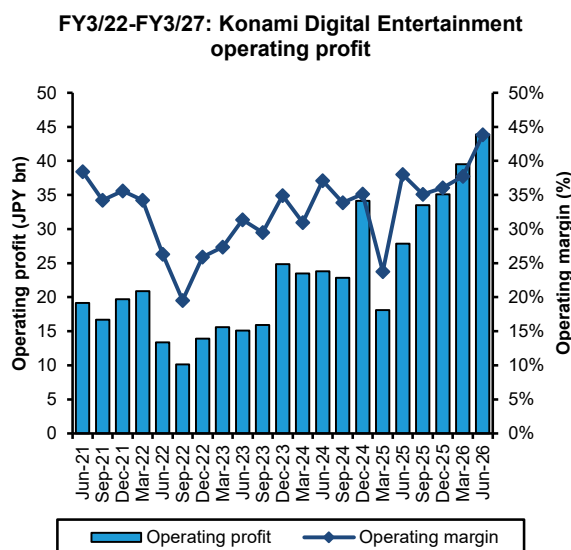
Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 7: Mobile games sales reached JPY65.4bn, contributing 65.3% of total Digital Entertainment revenue



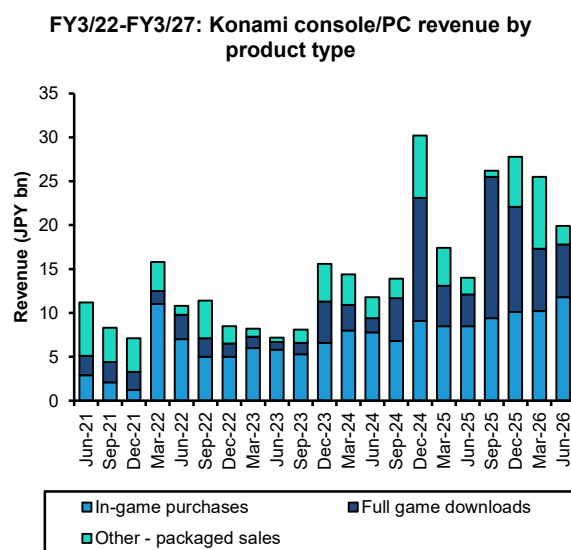
Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 6: Digital Entertainment operating profit reached JPY43.9bn, implying a 43.8% margin



Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 8: In-game purchase revenue reached JPY11.8bn with a YoY growth of 38.8%



Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 9: Konami: Income Statement

JPY million	FY3/23	FY3/24	FY3/25	FY3/26	FY3/27E	FY3/28E	FY3/29E
Net sales	314,321	360,314	421,602	493,677	550,524	580,217	604,192
Cost of sales	-191,930	-200,277	-222,681	-250,498	-269,100	-278,683	-284,876
Gross profit	122,391	160,037	198,921	243,179	281,424	301,534	319,316
Selling, general & administrative expenses	76,206	79,775	96,977	107,288	108,062	102,657	97,839
Operating profit	46,185	80,262	101,944	135,891	173,362	198,877	221,477
Profit before tax	47,120	82,685	104,008	140,667	175,850	200,637	223,237
Total income taxes	12,225	23,513	29,316	40,654	50,110	56,178	62,506
Profit after tax	34,895	59,172	74,692	100,013	125,740	144,458	160,730
Earnings attributable to shareholders	34,895	59,171	74,692	100,013	125,740	144,458	160,730
Earnings per share	257.48	436.50	551.00	737.79	927.59	1,065.68	1,185.72

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 10: Konami: Cash Flow Statement

JPY million	FY3/23	FY3/24	FY3/25	FY3/26	FY3/27E	FY3/28E	FY3/29E
Net income before income taxes	34,895	59,172	74,692	100,013	125,740	144,458	160,730
Depreciation & amortisation	23,845	23,267	28,488	34,190	30,370	32,767	35,198
Interest income/expense, net	15,735	26,574	28,242	38,647	47,622	54,418	60,746
Net change in working capital	-12,389	1,038	-207	-9,893	6,161	2,301	1,481
Other	-25,988	-6,990	-16,595	-27,293	-48,162	-54,818	-61,146
Net cash from operating activities	36,098	103,061	114,620	135,664	161,731	179,126	197,010
Capex	-43,779	-29,316	-66,862	-55,680	-49,547	-52,220	-54,377
Payments for intangible assets	-98	-192	-1,288	-461	0	0	0
Other	1,091	292	265	818	0	0	0
Net cash from investing activities	-42,786	-29,216	-67,885	-55,323	-49,547	-52,220	-54,377
Net cash from financing activities	-27,467	-24,199	-25,784	-51,897	-37,722	-43,338	-48,219
Effect of FX changes	2,707	4,838	-482	4,904	0	0	0
Net change in cash and equivalents	-31,448	54,484	20,469	33,348	74,462	83,569	94,413
Period beginning cash and equivalents	250,711	219,263	273,747	294,216	327,564	402,026	485,594
Period end cash and equivalents	219,263	273,747	294,216	327,564	402,026	485,594	580,008
Free cash flow	-7,779	73,553	46,470	79,523	112,184	126,906	142,633

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 11: Konami: Balance Sheet

JPY million	FY3/23	FY3/24	FY3/25	FY3/26	FY3/27E	FY3/28E	FY3/29E
Cash and cash equivalents	219,263	273,747	294,216	327,564	402,026	485,594	580,008
Trade and other receivables	39,276	43,887	47,220	60,023	67,873	71,338	74,489
Inventories	12,705	13,764	12,108	18,968	18,432	19,036	19,512
Other current assets	18,797	12,462	13,292	17,959	20,027	21,107	21,979
Total current assets	290,041	343,860	366,836	424,514	508,357	597,075	695,988
Property, plant and equipment, net	155,788	154,454	163,617	187,186	206,364	225,817	244,995
Other non-current assets	101,394	107,536	134,587	137,065	137,605	138,005	138,405
Total assets	547,223	605,850	665,040	748,765	852,326	960,897	1,079,389
Trade and other payables	37,558	44,257	45,406	50,545	55,295	57,107	58,536
Other current liabilities	37,536	41,669	70,908	67,865	75,680	79,762	83,057
Total current liabilities	75,094	85,926	116,314	118,410	130,974	136,869	141,593
Long-term borrowings	59,819	59,862	39,911	39,936	39,936	39,936	39,936
Other current liabilities	36,031	32,684	26,947	25,866	28,844	30,400	31,656
Total liabilities	170,944	178,472	183,172	184,212	199,755	207,205	213,186
Total net assets	376,279	427,378	481,868	564,553	652,571	753,692	866,203
Total liabilities & net assets	547,223	605,850	665,040	748,765	852,326	960,897	1,079,389

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	30 Jul 2026		TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
			Closing Price	Price Target		Cur	2026A	2027E	2028E	2026A	2027E	2028E
9766.JP (Konami)	O	JPY	21,840	27,200	(30.1)%	JPY	737.79	927.59	1,065.68	29.6	23.5	20.5
OLD				26,800				896.16	1,032.05			
JPL			2,570.52									

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Konami Group Corporation**

We value Konami at JPY27,200 per share, on a 25x P/E multiple of FY+1 (i.e. quarters 5-8) EPS.

RISKS**Konami Group Corporation**

The main downside risks to our view on Konami and price target relate to (1) the success of key live service franchises like eFootball, baseball, and Yu-Gi-Oh!; (2) the success or failure of single title launches; and (3) broader operating leverage and future game releases. In the event of a severe macro slowdown, there may also be some downside risk to consumer appetite for video gaming.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp
- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 10 pp
- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Autonomous research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Autonomous brand common stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – preferred stocks

The Autonomous brand has three categories of preferred stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to outperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

AUTONOMOUS CREDIT RESEARCH

Where this report contains investment recommendations for credit instruments, as defined in article 3(1)(35) of the Market Abuse Regulation, the information below is presented to comply with its disclosure requirements.

The report may also include reference(s) to published opinions by other Autonomous or Bernstein analysts covering the equity securities of the issuer(s) referenced herein. Please note an investment recommendation for credit instruments published by the author(s) of this report may differ from the published view of the analyst covering equity securities for the issuer(s) contained in this report and vice versa.

CREDIT RATINGS DEFINITIONS

The Autonomous brand has three categories of credit ratings:

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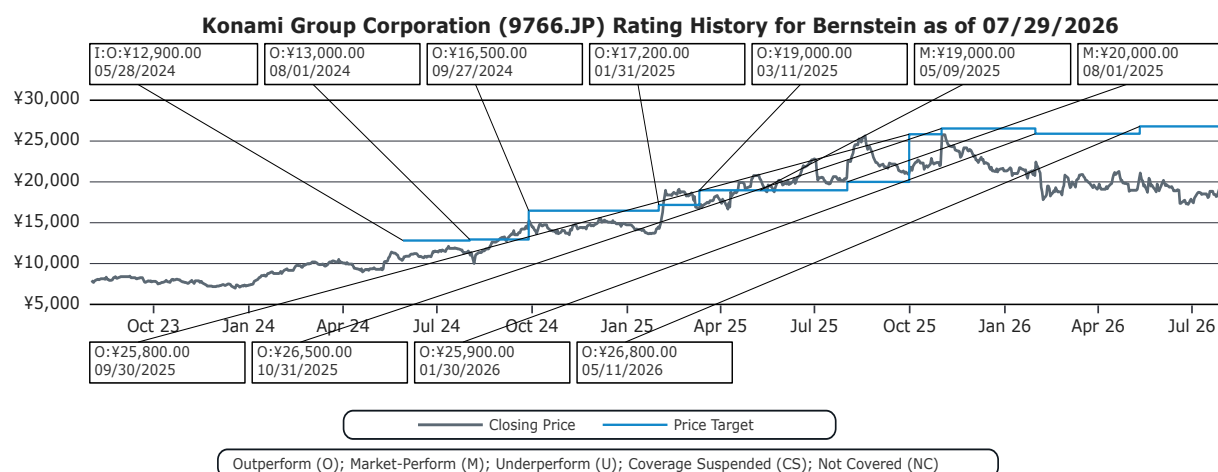
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